ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	22nd Commission Meeting
DATE:	08 April 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	**Present Talent Management Framework for implementation as the pilot agency – HRS** *HRS presented the RCSC's approved Talent Management Framework (TMF) for implementation in the ACC as the pilot agency. While noting that the approved TMF differs from the version originally submitted by the ACC, HRS apprised that the revised Framework aims to institutionalize talent management through application of the 9-box matrix as a single decision gateway along with clearly defined post-assessment interventions/incentives and the development of structured leadership and specialist succession pipelines.* *The Framework outlines continuous monitoring, periodic reviews, and validation of potential assessments as core approaches to identify, recognize, mentor, coach, and retain talent within agencies. To determine talent, performance assessment parameter will be based on the last two moderated cycles (OS/VG/G/PME), while agencies are required to validate potential assessment through criteria such as stretch assignments, officiating appointments, cross-functional or cross-agency exposure, high-visibility project management, and multi-year performance trends. Upon identification, the Framework provides for incentives including out-of-turn promotions ranging from six months to two years. It also requires the establishment of a Talent Steering Committee, chaired by the Head of the Agency with Department Heads as members.* *While noting the structured approach of the Framework, the Commission observed that it does not sufficiently incorporate innovative or differentiated interventions for talent recognition, development, and retention, as envisaged in the ACC's original proposal.*	**Noted with following specific directives:** - **two Commissioners to lead the exercise given the overview of the overall staff profile.** - **ensure that the Framework is not misused by officials to deliberately underperform or avoid leadership responsibilities.** - **assess the extent to which the exercise provides scope to incorporate the ACC's specific needs and requirements.** **Nominated following officials as the Talent Steering Committee:** 1. **Chairperson: A Karma Rinzin, Commissioner** 2. **Members:** a) **Gyeltshen, Commissioner;** b) **Wangay Dorji, Director, DoPS;** c) **Kin Dorji, Acting Director, DoPE; and** d) **Kelden Jamtsho, Acting Director, DoI.** 3. **Member Secretary: Tshewang Rinzin, Sr. HRO, HRS.**

	Nonetheless, the Commission emphasized the importance of leveraging the current pilot to integrate the ACC's specific requirements and contextual considerations within the implementation of the Framework.	
2	**Update on integration of drone in the Operational Command Control System – DoI & SS** *Commissioner Gyeltshen apprised the Commission on the proposed integration of drone technology into the Operational Command Control System (O2CS), informing that preliminary discussions on regulatory requirements are underway with the Secretary, MoIT.* *Given the concerns raised during the Finance Committee Meeting on the optimal use of drones, the Commission deliberated on the practical and regulatory considerations, including licensing requirements, the need for trained and certified operators, and adherence to operational parameters such as range and line-of-sight. The Commission also took note of existing practices among other government agencies in the use of drones and considered resource sharing as a possible interim arrangement.* *At the same time, the Commission emphasized the importance of integrating drone capabilities within the O2CS to assess system compatibility, particularly in relation to real-time data transmission and operational coordination. In this regard, it was noted that acquiring a dedicated drone compatible with the O2CS architecture would significantly enhance operational readiness. Recalling the prior use of drones during an insurance related investigation, the Commission further noted the potential for broader operational application including for DARe functions and support to ongoing cases.*	**Decided as follows:** • **procure one drone to facilitate integration with the O2CS for testing and operationalisation.** • **initiate necessary clearances with the relevant Ministry to ensure full compliance with all regulatory requirements.**
3	**Present comparative analysis on NIA, TI CPI, and recommendations – DoPE** *Following the directives of the Commission during the presentation of the 6th NIA findings and recommendations on 20 March 2026, EAD presented the review of recommendations provided across successive NIAs. It was highlighted that the recommendations have largely converged around key systemic areas, including:* • *service delivery standards and turnaround time;* • *accountability and monitoring mechanisms;* • *transparency in HR and budget management;* • *online services and digital transformation;* • *ethical leadership and code of conduct; and* • *grievance redress mechanisms and communication.*	**Noting the inherent challenges in deriving actionable recommendations from perception-based surveys, the Commission directed as follows:** - **finalize the recommendations for the 6th NIA.** - **explore independent third-party validation of the correlation between the NIA and TI-CPI.** - **leverage NIA findings to positively influence Bhutan's TI-CPI performance.**

	EAD further presented a comparative analysis of the NIA, Service Evaluation Tool (SET), and Public Service Satisfaction Survey (PSSS), conducted respectively by the ACC, RCSC, and NSB. The analysis indicated that while the NIA focuses on diagnosing corruption and governance issues in high-risk areas to inform reforms, the SET captures real-time service delivery performance based on user experience in commonly availed services, and the PSSS measures overall public satisfaction and trust across a wide range of services at the household level. *Additionally, EAD presented a comparative analysis between the NIA and TI-CPI, highlighting differences in methodology, design, sampling, tools, scoring systems, and focus areas. The analysis demonstrated a micro-macro correlation between the NIA and CPI, with the NIA serving as a bridging instrument to contextualize CPI findings. Further examination of low-scoring data sources contributing to Bhutan's CPI, particularly indicators related to public sector corrupt exchanges and judicial corruption decisions under the V-Dem dataset, revealed that NIA indicators substantially correspond to these dimensions. When NIA scores were moderated against V-Dem scales, the results showed comparable alignment, with NIA derived scores of 3.75 (public sector corrupt exchanges) and 3.72 (judicial corruption decisions) relative to V-Dem scores of 2.28 and 2.95 respectively, indicating broad consistency in underlying trends.*	- **undertake a detailed analysis of the successive decline in V-Dem scores since 2020 to identify underlying causes and inform remedial measures.** - **defer the launch of the 6th NIA pending further analysis.**
4	**Proposal on launching of CoRE Network – PPD & DARe** *PPD presented the proposal to coordinate the inaugural launch of the CoRE Network on 29 April 2026 at Zhichenkhar, CBS, following the successful completion of consultations with key stakeholders, namely the DLO, DRC, RBP, and RMA, with the final consultation held with the RBP on 23 January 2026. The proposal was not only well received by the stakeholders but also recommended the ACC to continue spearheading this initiative for its long-term sustainability.* *During the launch, PPD proposed to include adoption of the Protocol on the establishment of the CoRE Network, designation of Secretariat to support the Network either on rotational basis or permanent, and adoption of a six-month work plan to guide initial implementation.*	**Endorsed.**
5	**Update on Technical Assistance from CPIB on Polygraph – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the response received from the CPIB to the ACC's invitation to visit Bhutan for in-person technical experience sharing on the*	**Decided to accept the offer and directed the PPD & SS as follows:** - **coordinate three-day technical visit around**

	administration of polygraph equipment. While the CPIB expressed regret in accepting the invitation, it instead offered to host Sangay Khandu for a three-day visit at their facility. *The proposed visit is intended to facilitate exchange of technical and operational experiences, including:* - *understanding the curriculum undertaken during the basic polygraph course;* - *hands-on instrumentation testing to assess compatibility with the CPIB equipment;* - *sharing of procedures on administration of polygraph tests, including pre-test, in-test, and post-test stages;* - *guidance on question formulation for criminal and screening tests, including refinement of probable lie comparison techniques;* - *construction of test questions specific to corruption-related cases;* - *simulation exercises on test data analysis; and* - *demonstration of post-test interviews and interrogation based on polygraph results.* *The CPIB further indicated its preference to host the visit around mid-May 2026.* *The Commission acknowledged the offer and emphasized the need to optimise the opportunity, given the CPIB's extensive experience in the application of polygraph techniques in corruption investigations. Besides this, the offer also aligns with the ACC's plan to operationalise this function in the upcoming financial year.*	**mid-May 2026, as proposed, including arrangements for equipment testing.** - **facilitate direct flight to Singapore to minimise risks to equipment and avoid multiple airport clearances.** - **explore funding through savings and budget rationalization in the absence of an earmarked HRD budget.**
6	**Nomination of Focal Commissioner for UNCAC – PPD** *PPD sought Commission's directives on the nomination of a new focal Commissioner for UNCAC, in place of former Commissioner Jamtsho, as part of preparation for upcoming Country Review Cycle II for Latvia, scheduled in October 2026.*	**Nominated A Karma Rinzin, Commissioner as the focal Commissioner for UNCAC in view of current portfolio overseeing DoPE and alignment with Phase I of Review Cycle II on Prevention Measures and Asset Recovery.**
7	**Proposal on the change in the list of Governmental Experts for Phase 1 Cycle 2 – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the receipt of the Self-Assessment Checklist for the Draft Country Review Report of Latvia under Phase I of Review Cycle II of UNCAC. The UNODC informed that the country visit is tentatively scheduled for October 2026, with the desk review expected to be completed prior to the visit.* *To this, PPD apprised that several of the previously nominated Governmental Experts have since been transferred, promoted, or separated, necessitating a review of the composition of the expert group. The originally nominated experts were as follows:*	**Endorsed the proposed replacement of Governmental Experts. Further, directed to replace Gyeltshen, Commissioner as it is already represented by Kelden Jamtsho, AD, DoI.**

	1) *Jamtsho, Commissioner, ACC;* 2) *Gyeltshen, Director, DoI, ACC;* 3) *Phuntsho Gyaltshen Dorji, Offtg. DAG, OAG;* 4) *Sherab Tharchen, LO, ACC;* 5) *Kelzang Dema, LO, ACC;* 6) *Kinley Namgay, Chief Judge, Thimphu District Court;* 7) *Tshewang Rinzin, Offtg. DCOP, RBP;* 8) *Choki Drakpa, SLO, RCSC;* 9) *Tashi Tshering, LO, MoLHR;* 10) *Thinley Cheki, Analyst, FIU, RMA;* 11) *Prem Mani Pradhan, DAG, RAA;* 12) *Karma Wangdi, CPO, DPP, MoF;* 13) *Deki Yangzom, SLO, MoF;* 14) *Kelden Jamtsho, Head, LD, ACC; and* 15) *Damche Tenzin, Chief General Counsel, RMA.* *In this regard, PPD sought the Commission's directive on the replacement of select experts, particularly from within the ACC, to ensure continuity and strengthen inputs aligned with the focus on prevention and education measures. Accordingly, PPD proposed the nomination of the following officials as replacements:* 1) *Tenzin Phuntsho, ED, DoPE, ACC, in place of Tshewang Rinzin (RBP);* 2) *Tashi Wangchuk, PD, DoPE, ACC, in place of Choki Drakpa (RCSC);* 3) *Sonam Tshering, LD, ACC, in place of Tashi Tshering (MoLHR);* 4) *Tshering Choden, LD, ACC, in place of Prem Mani Pradhan (RAA); and* 5) *Kinley Wangmo, PPD, ACC, in place of Karma Wangdi (MoF).*	
8	**Nomination of Governmental Experts as Reviewer for Latvia Phase 1 Cycle 2 – PPD** *PPD sought the Commission's directive on the nomination of experts from the approved list to represent Bhutan during the upcoming country visit to Latvia. PPD informed that, in previous review cycles for Japan and Thailand, Bhutan's expert team typically comprised of a three-member delegation led by a Commissioner, with one representative from the LD (ACC) and an additional member nominated (within or outside ACC) based on relevance such as the inclusion of an OAG representative in the review for Japan.*	**Nominated following officials from the updated list for the country visit to Latvia in October 2026:** **1) A Karma Rinzin, Commissioner;** **2) Kelzang Dema, Head, LD; and** **3) Tenzin Phuntsho, Head, ED, DoPE.**
9	**Invitation to the 17th Session of the Implementation Review Group (IRG) and inter-governmental working group meeting on the prevention of corruption – PPD** *PPD sought the nomination from Commission to lead the delegation for the upcoming 17th Session of the IRG and Inter-Governmental Working Group meeting on the*	**Nominated A Karma Rinzin, Commissioner as focal to UNCAC.**

	prevention of corruption at Vienna, Austria from 18-22 May 2026.	
10	**Invitation to Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific (ACI) 2026 Regional Seminar – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the upcoming Regional Seminar themed "**partnering across public and private sectors to foster integrity and fight corruption in Asia and the Pacific**" to be held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan from 12-14 May 2026. The Secretariat has indicated that, at this stage, funding support can be extended to two participants, covering economy return airfare, accommodation, and per diem. It was further informed that consideration for additional participants will be made upon completion of the registration process.* *PPD also informed that Gyeltshen, Commissioner, has been nominated as Co-Chair for the Law Enforcement Network (LEN) meeting during the 19th Commission Meeting following the invitation from the Secretariat, a closed-door forum among investigators held in parallel with the Public Integrity Network (PIN) and Business Integrity Network (BIN) sessions.* *Given that this platform represents a key regional forum consistently engaged by the ACC including hosting of regional seminars in Bhutan (2016 & 2024) and noting that this would be the first such engagement following the assumption of office by the current Commission, PPD recommended the participation of the Chairperson to strengthen regional engagement on anti-corruption initiatives.* *In addition, while there is no earmarked HRD budget, and noting the possibility of additional funding support, the HRC nominated Kelden Jamtsho, AD, DoI, to attend the LEN meeting, and Kinley Wangmo, PPD, to attend the PIN meeting and accompany the Commission.*	**Endorsed and directed to explore funding for the two officials through internal savings in the event that external support does not materialise.**
11	**Update on hosting of Expert Meeting on Measuring Effectiveness of ACA – PPD** *PPD sought the Commission's directive on hosting the Asia Regional Expert Meeting on Measuring the Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies (ACA) from 16-18 June 2026. To this, while budget provision for the programme has been proposed in the upcoming FY, PPD proposed to utilise savings from the currently allocated budget for hosting the CPIB team on technical experience sharing on polygraph equipment and other programmes.*	**Endorsed.**
12	**Invitation from RAA to nominate a panel member for vetting best audit reports – PPD** *PPD sought the Commission's directive on the request from the RAA to nominate one officer as a panel*	**Nominate Sangay Bidha, SIPO, DoI.**

	member to vet audit reports on financial, compliance, and performance to determine best audit report for the year.	
13	Others - Debrief on the visit to the Regional Offices, Schools, Institutes, and Dzongkhag Administrations	**Directed to coordinate debriefing after Commissioner returns from the GMC Volunteer and involve respective RDs to update on their respective regions.**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**